Phat Cao

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Aspiring Data Scientist and Master of Data Science candidate at RMIT University with hands-on experience in machine learning and NLP classification. Proven ability to build and evaluate text classification models using Python, scikit-learn, and Hugging Face Transformers, and integrate model outputs into data workflows. Skilled in Python, SQL, and data preprocessing, with growing exposure to cloud and MLOps concepts. Eager to contribute to data-driven decision-making and AI deployment in real-world environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Framework**: .NET 8 Web API, ASP.NET Core (Razor Pages), React.js, Flask, LangChain
- **Language:** Python, SQL, C#, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS,
- **AI:** Hugging Face Transformers, DistilBERT, scikit-learn, Pandas, Ollama, RAG pipelines
- **Database:** PostgreSQL, Microsoft SQL Server, Entity Framework Core, Data Modelling,
- **Methodologies:** Agile (Scrum, Kanban), Secure data handling, MVC architecture

WORK EXPERIENCE

DATA SCIENCE INTERN

Telecommunications Industry Ombudsman — March, 2025 – Current

- Built a prototype system to automatically generate narrative insights from structured data using LLMs, reducing manual reporting effort and improving consistency of outputs.
- Developed and tested prompt templates (Jinja2) to produce structured, repeatable insights aligned with existing business reports.
- Integrated data from Power BI into Microsoft Fabric (Notebook + Lakehouse) and prepared datasets for insight generation, ensuring accuracy and alignment with validated metrics.

SERVICE DESK ASSISTANT

Optus — Jan, 2025 – Current

- Provided Level 1 technical support across different hardware and software diagnoses and connectivity issues across mobile devices. Resolved users' account-related problems in a high-volume environment, achieving a 99% customer satisfaction rating.
- Managed and escalated users' cases through internal systems, Jarvis and Salesforce, ensuring timely resolution and clear documentation using the SAO (Situation, Action, Outcome) format, with full end-to-end case ownership.
- Assisted with device setup and provisioning, including iOS and Android onboarding, SIM activation and reactivation, device migration, and basic hardware and software troubleshooting.
- Supported customers with fixed and broadband services, assisting with modem/router setup, basic LAN connectivity, and service verification in-store.

PERSONAL PROJECT

TEXT CLASSIFICATION - CLOTHING REVIEW RECOMMENDATION — Sept, 2025 – Dec, 2025

Project Demo: https://youtu.be/HzJsgSMVjiQ

Project Repo: https://github.com/bocongamco/Clothing-Review.git

- Cleaned and prepared a noisy dataset of ~19.7k clothing reviews provided by the lecturer using Python (pandas), converting raw text and categorical labels into analysis-ready formats (binary labels 1/0).
- Engineered and compared multiple text representations (Count-based, unweighted embeddings, TF-IDF embeddings) to evaluate their impact on classification performance.
- Trained and evaluated classification models using logistic regression with k-fold cross-validation, comparing accuracy and macro F1-score to select the most effective representation.
- Integrated the trained model into a local Flask web application, enabling real-time prediction on unseen review text for demonstration purposes.

NLP TEXT CLASSIFICATION - FLIRT SENSE Dec, 2025 - Jan, 2026

Project Repo: https://github.com/bocongamco/Flirt-or-not

- Designed an NLP text classification system to detect flirting intent in chat messages, inspired by real-world ambiguity observed on TikTok and short-form messaging platforms.
- Generated and curated a synthetic dataset of ~5,000 chat messages using GPT, intentionally enforcing noise and class imbalance to better reflect real conversational data.
- Preprocessed and structured text data with cleaning, tokenisation, and train/validation/test splitting to ensure reliable model evaluation.
- Implemented a DistilBERT-based classifier using Hugging Face Transformers, achieving ~96–97% accuracy on held-out data.
- Enhanced prediction interpretability by exposing confidence scores, helping users understand uncertainty in borderline cases while acknowledging the subjective nature of flirting detection.

EDUCATION

RMIT UNIVERSITY Melbourne, 3000

Master of Data Science Expected Dec 2026

Cumulative GPA: 3.2/4.0

MONASH UNIVERSITY Melbourne, 3168

Bachelor of Information and Technology Jul 2023

MONASH College Melbourne, 3168

Diploma of Information and Technology Jun 2021

REFERENCES

Available upon request